CHECKMAYBE

Listing Photo Checklist

5 checks before you post a product photo

What your photo file tells marketplaces, platforms and buyers, and what to fix before you list.

01	02	03	04
CHECK THE FILE	FIX WHAT IT SHOWS	DISCLOSE	LIST

> *"The photo is part of the listing. So is what the file says."*

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 5 CHECKS
- ETSY PHOTO RULES, OCT 2026
- FREE PHOTO CHECK TOOL
- OFFICIAL SOURCES

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5 checks before you post a product photo

Run these on every listing photo, especially photos you edited or made with AI.

1

Keep one unedited photo

Most Etsy listings now need one unedited photo of the actual item on a real background. Keep the original from your camera roll.

2

Say so if AI made or edited it

Many AI tools write a marker into the file that platforms read. Etsy expects AI use in the listing description; Instagram and Facebook may label it.

3

Remove a saved location

Phone photos can store where they were taken, and anyone who downloads the original file can read it. Remove it before you share originals.

4

Check what else the file says

The camera, the date and the editing app can stay in the file. Make sure nothing there contradicts what your listing says.

5

Show the real item

Color, size, condition and flaws should match what the buyer receives. If the item is materially different, you may have to refund.

KEEP THE ORIGINALS

Chat apps, social media and many design tools save images without their data. Keep the original files and the date you took them, in case a listing is questioned.

Check a photo in 30 seconds

CheckMaybe Photo Check reads the file in your browser. Your photo is never uploaded. checkmaybe-photo-check.pages.dev

1

Open Photo Check

On a computer or phone: checkmaybe-photo-check.pages.dev

2

Choose the original file

Pick it from your camera roll or folder, not a copy sent through a chat app or saved from social media.

3

Read the verdict

See the camera data, editing apps, AI markers, Content Credentials and saved location the file still carries.

4

Do the to-do list

Under “Still for you to check”: what to disclose, what to remove and which photo can be your unedited one.

WHAT IT CAN’T PROVE

Missing AI markers don’t prove an image isn’t AI-made, and camera data doesn’t prove a photo was never edited. Platforms also use their own detection.

Official sources

Rules change. Check the current version before you rely on it.

Etsy — Listing Image Requirements

https://www.etsy.com/legal/policy/listing-image-requirements/253962679005

Checked 24 October 2026 · Last updated October 22, 2026

Etsy — What’s Etsy’s Stance on AI Creations?

https://www.etsy.com/seller-handbook/article/1275449912004

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Etsy — Important updates to AI use on Etsy

https://www.etsy.com/seller-handbook/article/1522733284810

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Meta — Labeling AI-generated images on Facebook, Instagram and Threads

https://about.fb.com/news/2024/02/labeling-ai-generated-images-on-facebook-instagram-and-threads/

Published February 6, 2024 · Says Meta reads C2PA and IPTC metadata

C2PA — Content Credentials

https://c2pa.org/

Standard used by Photo Check · How AI tools sign and label images

Photo Check facts come from CheckMaybe’s own tests in October 2026: ChatGPT and Canva AI images carried AI markers; photos saved from chat apps and Etsy listings had their data removed.

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